

Home prep checklist

Do this while the roads are still ordinary. Leave if your zone is ordered out.

General information, not professional, insurance, or legal advice. Always follow official evacuation orders from your county.

Know the order

- ☐ Look up the evacuation zone and write it down
- ☐ Check the National Hurricane Center and NWS Tampa Bay
- ☐ Name where you will go, and an out-of-area contact
- ☐ If officials order your zone to evacuate, leave immediately

Supplies and the car

- ☐ Water and food for at least seven days, at one gallon of water per person per day
- ☐ Prescriptions toward a two-week supply, with a written list
- ☐ Gas tank at least half full, or the charge your vehicle manual calls for
- ☐ Go-bag staged by the door
- ☐ Phones charged, backup battery packed

Openings and garage

- ☐ Rated shutters or properly secured 5/8-inch plywood, after checking with the local building official
- ☐ Garage door hardware tight, door locked, brace kit if the door is weak
- ☐ Garage windows covered the way the house windows are
- ☐ Vehicles pulled toward the back wall - and Hillsborough's separate EV rules read if flooding is expected

Yard and pool

- ☐ Gutters and downspouts clear
- ☐ Furniture, toys, grills, and other loose objects inside when a warning is issued
- ☐ No piles of branches left in the yard
- ☐ Pool not drained; water super-chlorinated; pool power off

Sources

Florida Division of Emergency Management - Planning for Your Home -

<https://www.floridadisaster.org/planprepare/home/>

Florida Division of Emergency Management - 2024 Hurricane Guide (PDF) -

<https://www.floridadisaster.org/globalassets/fdem-hurricane-guide-2024.pdf>

Florida Division of Emergency Management - Know Your Zone - <https://www.floridadisaster.org/knowyourzone/>

Ready.gov - Hurricanes - <https://www.ready.gov/hurricanes>

Pinellas County Emergency Management - Make a Plan - <https://pinellas.gov/make-a-plan/>

Pinellas County - Secure Your Home - <https://pinellas.gov/plan-home-preparation/>

Hillsborough County - Protect your home during severe weather -

<https://hcfl.gov/residents/stay-safe/plan/protect-your-home-business-and-valuables-during-severe-weather>

National Hurricane Center - <https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/>

National Weather Service Tampa Bay - <https://www.weather.gov/tbw/>